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Notes on

INDIAN ARMY

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Indian Army

The safety, honour and welfare of your country come first, always and every time. The honour, welfare and comfort of the men you command come next. Your own ease, comfort and safety come last, always and every time.

- Field Marshal Philip Chetwode

(at the Inauguration of the IMA on 10 December 1932)

India Armed Forces are at the forefront of the country's National Security. Although the modern Indian Army traces back its origin to the Imperial British Army, the distinguished history of Army and warriors dates back more than ten thousand years in India. Security, both external and internal is a fundamental need of every society. In early history, people were led in war by tribal leaders; this was followed by rise of kingdoms which employed large standing armies consisting of Cavalry, Archers, Elephants, and Infantry. As per literary records, the Army of Chandragupta Maurya consisted of 60000 foot-soldiers, 30000 cavalry, 9000 elephants and 8000 chariots. Babur used the Gunpowder for first time in India and established Mughal rule in India.

Motto of Indian Army: Service Before Self

1. History of the Indian Army:

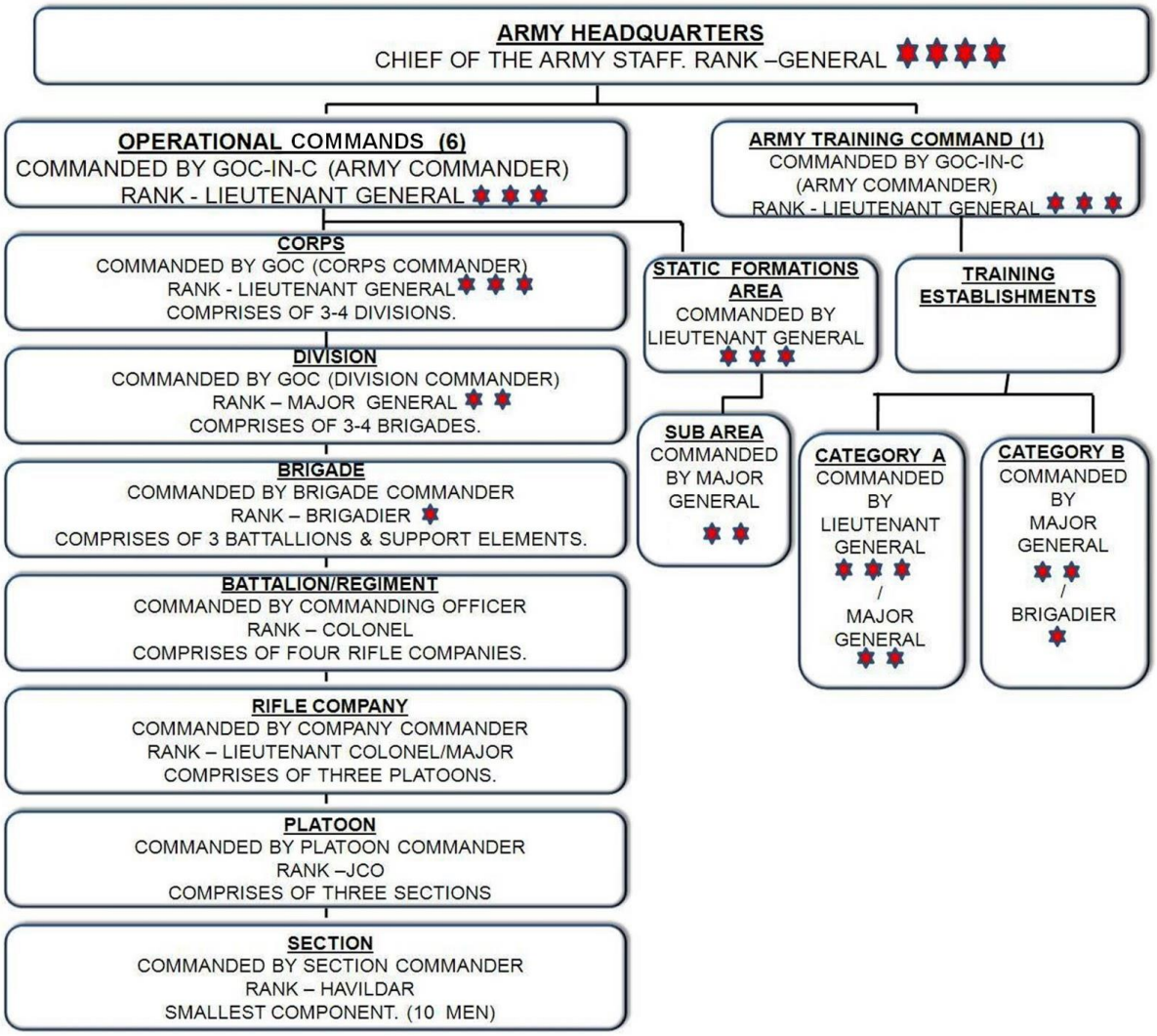
- The modern Indian Army goes back to the mid sixteenth century when Europeans, similar to the French, Dutch, Portuguese and British, settled in India as brokers.
- Major General Stringer Lawrence reorganised the Madras Army and is also referred as '**the father of the Indian Army'**. In 1748, He was appointed as the **first Commander-in-Chief** of the East India Company's field forces in India with its headquarters at Fort St. David, Madras.
- After the Battle of Plassey (1757) the first regular Indian infantry battalions were raised, each with an establishment of one British captain, two lieutenants, several British sergeants, 42 Indian non-commissioned officers and 820 Indian ranks and file.
- The Indian Soldiers of the company revolted against the British in 1857. After the revolt the Army was again reorganised based on the recommendation of Peel Commission.
- In 1895 the Presidency Armies were abolished and the process commenced of dividing Indian Army into four commands that is Punjab, Bengal, Madras and Bombay.
- Over 1.5 million soldiers from Indian Subcontinent took part in the World War I on behalf of the British Government. The gallant Indian Soldiers earned **11 Victoria Cross, 5 Military Cross, 973 Indian Order of Merit & 3130 Indian Distinguished Service Medals** during the First World War.
- The British government, in June 1918, gave guidelines for the selection of Indian cadets for passage into the Royal Military College at Sandhurst. Field Marshal Cariappa was a renowned individual from the first clump of Indian Commissioned officers.
- The Indian Military Academy was set up in 1932 after a suggestion by a military committee set up under the chairmanship of Field Marshal Philip Chetwode.
- Indian forces also took part in the Second World War (1939-1945).
- At the time of independence the old Indian Army comprised 28 artillery regiments. Of these, India was allocated 18 and half regiments and Pakistan was given 18 and half regiments.

Indian Army Day is celebrated on **15 January** as on 15 January 1949, Lieutenant General **K. M. Cariappa became the first Indian commander-in-chief** of the Indian Army. General Sir Francis Butcher, the last British commander-in-chief of India handed over the charge to Lieutenant General

- Since Independence Indian Army has fought First Kashmir War (1947), Indo-China War (1962), Indo-Pakistani War of 1965, Indo-Pakistani War of 1971, Siachen Conflict (1984) and Kargil War (1999).
- The Indian Army also took active part in:
    - **Operation Polo** (Assimilation of Hyderabad into India, 1948)
    - **Operation Vijay** (Annexation of Goa, Daman and Diu, 1961)
    - **Operation Blue Star** (Against separatist leader Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale, 1984)
    - **Operation Meghdoot** to reclaim Siachin Glacier in 1984.
    - **Operation Pawan** against LTTE in Sri Lanka (1987).
    - **Operation Black Tornado** and Operation Cyclone in the wake of 2008 Mumbai terror attacks.

2. Organization of the Indian Army:

- In India, the President is the supreme commander of Armed Forces. Indian Army comes under the jurisdiction and control of the Ministry of Defence Minister, Government of India.
- The Defence Minster of India is aided by the Defence Secretary and the newly created Chief of Defence Staff.
    - The Post of Chief of Defence Staff along with the Department of Military Affairs (DMA) was created by Indian Government in Dec 2019.
    - The Chief of Defence Staff, apart from being the head of the Department of Military Affairs, is also the **Permanent Chairman of the Chiefs of Staff Committee**.
    - He also acts as the Principal Military Adviser to Defence Minister on all tri-Services matters.
    - General Bipin Rawat has become India's first Chief of Defence Staff.



Source: Indianarmy.nic.in

- The *headquarters of Indian Army* is located in New Delhi.
- The Chief of Army Staff is four star officers with the Rank of General.

2.1 Commands of the Indian Army:

There are **6 operational commands** and one training command of the Indian Army commanded by a three-star officer (Lieutenant General).

Commands	Headquarters
Eastern Command	Kolkata
Western Command	Chandimandir
Northern Command	Udhampur
Southern Command	Pune
South Western Command	Jaipur
Central Command	Lucknow
Training Command	Shimla

2.2 Arms and Services of Indian Army:

The Indian Army consists of various Arms and Services to fight battles and carry out day to day administration and maintenance tasks.

- **Combat Arms:** Infantry, Mechanised Infantry and Armoured Corps.
- **Combat Support Arms:** Corps of Engineers, Corps of Signals, Army Aviation Corps, Regiment of Artillery, and Army Air Defence.

Arms	Services
Infantry	Army Service Corps
Regiment of Artillery	Army Ordnance Corps
Corps of Engineers	Army Medical Corps
Corps of Signals	Army Education Corps
Armoured Corps	Corps of Electrical and Mechanical Engineers
Army Air Defence	Military Nursing Service
Mechanised Infantry	Corps of Military Police
Army Aviation Corps	Intelligence corps
	Army Dental Corps

2.2.1 Infantry:

"The least spectacular of all arms, but without which you can do nothing, nothing at all".

- The above quote of Field Marshal Montgomery about the utility of Infantry battalions is true verbatim. Infantry is referred as **Queen of battles**.
- Even today, when technology has changed military warfare, the role of the foot soldiers (Infantrymen) remains crucial. They engage directly with the enemy in close combat and eliminate the target. The Infantry is the largest and most potent combat arm of Indian Army.
- Apart from fighting wars, Infantry also undertake several civic actions. It is the first one to be mobilised in any natural calamity, be it an earthquake, floods, avalanche or a train accident. In remote areas, a number of welfare projects have been initiated for the development of the local residents.
- The Infantry regiments of Indian Army are: Madras Regiment, Rajputana Rifle, Rajput Regiment, Bihar Regiment, Dogra Regiment, Sikh Regiment, Jat Regiment, The Grenadiers, Punjab Regiment, The Garhwal Rifles, Kumaon Regiment, Assam Regiment, Mahar Regiment, Jammu & Kashmir Rifles,Naga Regiment etc.

2.2.2 Regiment of Artillery:

- **Motto:** Sarvatra Izat-o-Iqbal (Everywhere with Honour and Glory)
- The Regiment of Artillery in India was raised on 28 September 1827 with the raising of Bombay Artillery.
- 28 September is celebrated as the "Gunners Day".
- The Artillery has guns, mortars, rocket launchers, unmanned aerial vehicles, surveillance systems, missiles and artillery firepower. It enables maximum damage to the enemy from a distance. It is also used to destroy the firepower of the enemy.
- The School of Artillery of the Indian Army is situated at Devlali near Nashik (Maharashtra)

2.2.3 Armoured Corps:

- Armoured Day is praised on 01 May each year to celebrate the initiation of motorization of the Indian Cavalry regiments. On this date in 1938, The Scinde Horse turned into the principal regiment to shed their horses and to be outfitted with tanks.
- Armoured corps is considered modern-day cavalry. Tanks bring speed and mobility to the battlefields. The Indian Army's 3,000 plus tanks are divided among some 60 armoured regiments; each one with about 50 tanks and other vehicles.
- The Corps has engraved its name in world military warfare by defeating the superior Patton tanks of Army by its own Centurion ranks and converting Khemkaran into 'graveyards of Patton' during 1965 Indo-Pak war.
- Currently the Armoured Corps School and its Centre is at Ahmednagar.

2.2.4 Mechanised Infantry:

- **Motto:** Valour & Faith
- The Mechanised Infantry is today the youngest regiment of the Indian Army. This regiment was formed to provide greater mobility to Infantry regiments. After the 1965 Indo-Pak War, a need was felt to provide matching mobility to infantry units operating with armoured formations. Thus the Mechanised Infantry was born.
- It was the brainchild of Gen K Sundarji. The Mechanised Infantry was raised on 2 April 1979. At the beginning mechanised infantry regiments were equipped with Armoured Personnel Carriers (APCs), TOPAZ, SKOT and BTR-60.
- The Mechanized Infantry Regimental Center (MIRC) is situated in Ahmednagar

2.2.5 Corps of Engineers

- **Motto:** Sarvatra (Everywhere)
- The Corps of Engineers follows back its starting point to 1780 when the two ordinary pioneer organizations of the Madras Sappers were raised. Subsequently, the **Madras Sappers, the Bengal Sappers and the Bombay Sappers** were merged on 18 November 1932 to form the Corps of Engineers in its present form.
- It provides mobility to forces by constructing bridges, tracks and helipads; and also stalls the mobility of enemy by laying mine-fields and demolition of bridges.
- College of Military Engineering, Pune (CME) is the premier technical and tactical training institution of the corps.

2.2.6 Corps of Signals

- **Motto:** Teevra Chaukas (Swift and Alert)
- The corps was formed on 15 February 1911 under Lieutenant Colonel S H Powell.
- The Corps of Signals deals with Military communication. They provide battlefield communications and information systems essential to all operations.
- In today's interconnected world of information Technology (IT), the role of Corps of signals remains crucial for data communications, weapon control and weapon management systems.
- The Military College of Telecommunication Engineering (MCTE), Mhow is a debut preparing foundation of the Corps of Signals.

2.2.7 Army Aviation

- **Motto:** Suveg Va Sudrid (Swift and Sure)
- The Army Aviation Corps is the aviation arm of the Indian Army. It was formed on 1 November 1986.
- The attack helicopters such as the Mil Mi-25/Mi-35 and HAL Rudra are under the operational control of the Indian army. Helicopters, for example, the HAL Chetak, HAL Cheetah and HAL Dhruv offer logistical help for the Indian Army in remote and distant zones
- The Army Aviation Corps also perform combat search and rescue (CSAR), artillery lift, combat transportation, logistics relief, military prisoner transportation and medical evacuation (MEDEVAC) in wartime and during natural disasters.
- The Army Aviation Corps likewise perform combat search and salvage (CSAR), artillery lift, combat transportation, coordinations help, military detainee transportation and medical evacuation (MEDEVAC) in wartime and during cataclysmic events.
- The Combat Army Aviation Training School (CATS) is located in Nashik.

2.2.8 Army Air Defence

- **Motto:** Akashe Shatrun Jahi (Kill the Enemy in the Sky)
- The Corps of Army Air Defence is responsible for the protection of Indian air space from enemy aircraft and missiles, especially below 5,000 feet.
- The threat of an air attack from Japanese forces during Second World War forced British to train Indian Soldiers to use 3-inch Ack-Ack guns and Bofors 40 mm L/60 guns. Thus their origin is traced back to 1939.
- Started as the Corps of Air Defence Artillery, it was re-designated as 'Corps of Army Air Defence' on 18 April 2005.

3. Ranking Structure:

Shoulder Insignia

3.1 Commissioned officers:

- General
- Lieutenant General
- Major General
- Brigadier
- Colonel
- Lieutenant Colonel
- Major
- Captain
- Lieutenant

*The rank of the second lieutenant in Indian Army was abolished on the recommendation of **Ajai Vikram Singh (AVS) Cadre Review 2006.**

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3.2 Junior Commissioned Officers:

- Subedar Major
- Subedar
- Naib Subedar

3.3 Non Commissioned Officers:

- Havildar
- Naik
- Lance Naik
- Sepoy

4. Weapons of Indian Army:

4.1 Army Aviation:

- HAL Dhruv
- HAL Chetak
- HAL Cheetah
- HAL Light Combat Helicopter **(Attack Helicopter)**
- HAL Light Utility Helicopter
- Boeing AH-64 **(Attack Helicopter)**
- Kamov Ka-226
- HAL Rudra **(Attack Helicopter)**

4.2 Unarmed Ariel Vehicles (UAVs)

- IAI Heron
- IAI Searcher
- DRDO RUSTAM

4.3 Artillery:

- Dhanush Howitzer
- DRDO Advanced Towed Artillery Gun System (ATAGS)
- M-46
- Indian Field Gun MK 1/2/3
- K9 Thunder
- Pinaka MBRL

4.4 Tanks:

- Arjun MK-III
- T-90S "Bhishma"
- T-72 Ajeya

4.5 Infantry:

A. Small Arms:

- Pistol Auto 9mm 1A
- SIG Sauer P226
- Glock 17

B. Assault Rifles:

- 1B1 INSAS
- FN SCAR
- IMI Tavor TAR-21
- AKM
- AR-M1
- AK-103
- AK-203

C. Machine Guns:

- INSAS LMG
- IMI Negev (LMG)
- MG 2A1
- NSV (HMG)

D. Fighting vehicles

- Abhay IFV
- BMP-2 'Sarath'
- BMP-1

4.6 Missiles:

A. Ballistic Missiles:

- Prahaar
- Prithvi-I
- Prithvi-II
- Prithvi-III
- Agni series

B. Cruise Missiles:

- Barhmos
- Nirbhay

C. Surface to Air Missiles (SAM):

- Barak-8
- Akash